

STAGE SIXTEEN • WORKPLACE PROFESSIONALISM & ETHICS

# FIRSTS

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## SESSION PLAN

*Five sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 45 FIRSTS as a live workshop*

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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# FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Sixteen • Workplace Professionalism & Workplace Readiness / Professional Ethics & Integrity

## OVERVIEW

Stage Sixteen's forty-five FIRSTS split across five sessions, matching the Manual's existing structure: Workplace Fundamentals, Navigating Workplace Situations, and Performance & Professional Identity cover workplace professionalism; Ethical Foundations & Responsibilities and Applied Ethics & Integrity Reflection cover ethics. This is the largest stage in the program — plan for five full sessions, not three.

Sessions 4 and 5 involve more emotionally weighted reflection than most other stages — real ethical dilemmas, real pressure to compromise, honest integrity gaps. Build in genuine room for this rather than treating it as equivalent pacing to the more procedural Sections 1-2.

## AT A GLANCE

| Time      | Segment                                          | Format   |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Session 1 | Workplace Fundamentals — T1-T9                   | ~110 min |
| Session 2 | Navigating Workplace Situations — T10-T16        | ~105 min |
| Session 3 | Performance & Professional Identity — T17-T25    | ~120 min |
| Session 4 | Ethical Foundations & Responsibilities — T26-T35 | ~130 min |
| Session 5 | Applied Ethics & Integrity Reflection — T36-T45  | ~130 min |

## SESSION 1

### Workplace Fundamentals

*Covers FIRSTS T1-T9: Workplace Orientation, Professional Workplace Routine, Workplace Etiquette Awareness, Professional Appearance Standard, Workplace Punctuality Habit, Workplace Accountability Practice, Workplace Ownership Experience, Workplace Initiative, Workplace Adaptation.*

## PRE-WORK

- No advance preparation required. If any participants are currently in a new role or internship, ask them to bring one real question they still have about workplace expectations.

## SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                                      | Format     |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 0:00-0:10 | Welcome + framing: this stage is the trust layer underneath every other skill in the program | Full group |
| 0:10-0:25 | FIRST T1 — Workplace Orientation                                                             | Solo       |
| 0:25-0:40 | FIRST T2 — Professional Workplace Routine                                                    | Solo       |
| 0:40-0:55 | FIRST T3 — Workplace Etiquette Awareness                                                     | Solo       |
| 0:55-1:00 | Short break                                                                                  | —          |

|           |                                                          |                             |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1:00–1:10 | FIRST T4 — Professional Appearance Standard              | Solo                        |
| 1:10–1:20 | FIRST T5 — Workplace Punctuality Habit                   | Solo                        |
| 1:20–1:35 | FIRST T6 — Workplace Accountability Practice             | Solo                        |
| 1:35–1:50 | FIRST T7 — Workplace Ownership Experience                | Solo                        |
| 1:50–2:05 | FIRSTS T8-T9 — Workplace Initiative + Adaptation + close | Solo, then full-group share |

#### FACILITATOR NOTES

- Most FIRSTS in this session are genuinely quick (10–15 min) since they're building awareness and habit, not producing a complex artifact — resist the urge to pad them out.
- T3, T4, and T9 all ask participants to observe real workplace norms; if some participants aren't currently in a workplace, have them reference a past internship, job, or even a structured academic environment.

## SESSION 2

# Navigating Workplace Situations

*Covers FIRSTS T10–T16: Workplace Policy Review, Confidentiality Awareness, Professional Boundary, Workplace Prioritization Exercise, Workplace Escalation, Workplace Mistake Recovery, Workplace Accountability Conversation.*

### PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one real professional boundary they've been avoiding stating, for use in FIRST T12.

### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                                         | Format                      |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + bridge: Session 1 built habits; today builds judgment for specific, harder situations | Full group                  |
| 0:10–0:25 | FIRST T10 — Workplace Policy Review                                                             | Solo                        |
| 0:25–0:40 | FIRST T11 — Confidentiality Awareness                                                           | Solo                        |
| 0:40–0:55 | FIRST T12 — Professional Boundary                                                               | Solo                        |
| 0:55–1:00 | Short break                                                                                     | —                           |
| 1:00–1:15 | FIRST T13 — Workplace Prioritization Exercise                                                   | Solo                        |
| 1:15–1:30 | FIRST T14 — Workplace Escalation                                                                | Solo                        |
| 1:30–1:45 | FIRST T15 — Workplace Mistake Recovery                                                          | Solo                        |
| 1:45–2:05 | FIRST T16 — Workplace Accountability Conversation + close                                       | Solo, then full-group share |

### FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST T15 (Mistake Recovery) can surface genuine embarrassment about a past error — keep any group share explicitly opt-in.
- FIRST T16 closes the session on a genuinely harder note than it opened; don't rush the close-out immediately after — give it real room.

### SESSION 3

## Performance & Professional Identity

*Covers FIRSTS T17-T25: Performance Review, Performance Improvement Plan, Workplace Feedback Request, Workplace Recognition, Workplace Problem Ownership, Professional Reputation Audit, Workplace Culture Analysis, Workplace Readiness Assessment, Professional Standard Statement.*

#### PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one trusted colleague or peer they could genuinely ask for honest reliability feedback, for use in FIRST T22.

#### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                                                      | Format                                |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 0:00-0:10 | Welcome + framing: today is about how your work is actually perceived, not just how it feels from the inside | Full group                            |
| 0:10-0:25 | FIRST T17 — Performance Review: prep real examples and questions                                             | Solo                                  |
| 0:25-0:45 | FIRST T18 — Performance Improvement Plan                                                                     | Solo                                  |
| 0:45-0:55 | FIRST T19 — Workplace Feedback Request                                                                       | Solo                                  |
| 0:55-1:00 | Short break                                                                                                  | —                                     |
| 1:00-1:10 | FIRST T20 — Workplace Recognition                                                                            | Solo                                  |
| 1:10-1:25 | FIRST T21 — Workplace Problem Ownership                                                                      | Solo                                  |
| 1:25-1:40 | FIRST T22 — Professional Reputation Audit                                                                    | Solo (real ask happens after session) |
| 1:40-2:00 | FIRST T23 — Workplace Culture Analysis                                                                       | Solo                                  |
| 2:00-2:20 | FIRSTS T24-T25 — Readiness Assessment + Standard Statement + close                                           | Solo, then full-group share           |

#### FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST T22 can't be fully completed live — it requires a real conversation with a real colleague outside the session. Frame it as launched today, followed up on independently.
- FIRST T25 (Professional Standard Statement) is a genuine capstone for the first three sessions — give it real weight in the close-out, since Section 5 will directly reference it later (FIRST T41).

## SESSION 4

# Ethical Foundations & Responsibilities

*Covers FIRSTS T26–T35: Professional Ethics Awareness, Integrity Decision, Conflict of Interest Awareness, Confidential Information Responsibility, Data Ethics Awareness, Technology Ethics Awareness, Intellectual Property Awareness, Citation & Attribution Practice, Professional Honesty Challenge, Ethical Dilemma Analysis.*

### PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to reflect on one real ethical difficulty they've faced, even a minor one, for use in FIRST T27.
- Let participants know this session covers more emotionally weighted material than Sessions 1–3.

### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                                            | Format                      |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + framing: this session moves from professionalism to ethics — principles, not just habits | Full group                  |
| 0:10–0:25 | FIRST T26 — Professional Ethics Awareness                                                          | Solo                        |
| 0:25–0:45 | FIRST T27 — Integrity Decision                                                                     | Solo                        |
| 0:45–1:00 | FIRST T28 — Conflict of Interest Awareness                                                         | Solo                        |
| 1:00–1:05 | Short break                                                                                        | —                           |
| 1:05–1:20 | FIRST T29 — Confidential Information Responsibility                                                | Solo                        |
| 1:20–1:35 | FIRST T30 — Data Ethics Awareness                                                                  | Solo                        |
| 1:35–1:50 | FIRST T31 — Technology Ethics Awareness                                                            | Solo                        |
| 1:50–2:00 | FIRSTS T32–T33 — IP Awareness + Citation Practice                                                  | Solo                        |
| 2:00–2:20 | FIRST T34 — Professional Honesty Challenge                                                         | Solo                        |
| 2:20–2:40 | FIRST T35 — Ethical Dilemma Analysis + close                                                       | Solo, then full-group share |

### FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST T27 (Integrity Decision) and T34 (Professional Honesty Challenge) both ask participants to honestly assess a real past choice — give genuine space, and never require group disclosure.
- Consider splitting this session across two shorter meetings if a cohort's attention flags; this is one of the two longest sessions in the entire stage.

## SESSION 5

### Applied Ethics & Integrity Reflection

*Covers FIRSTS T36–T45: Compliance Awareness, Responsible AI Awareness, Privacy Awareness, Accountability Under Pressure, Ethical Leadership Reflection, Professional Integrity Reflection, Speak-Up Awareness, Ethical Decision Framework, Professional Responsibility Statement, Integrity Audit.*

#### PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring their Professional Standard Statement from FIRST T25 — it's directly referenced again in FIRST T41.
- This is the final session of the stage; let participants know they'll close with a full-stage reflection, not just a session-level one.

#### SESSION AGENDA

| Time      | Segment                                                                                                        | Format                      |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 0:00–0:10 | Welcome + framing: today applies everything from Session 4 to real, lived pressure and closes the entire stage | Full group                  |
| 0:10–0:25 | FIRST T36 — Compliance Awareness                                                                               | Solo                        |
| 0:25–0:40 | FIRST T37 — Responsible AI Awareness                                                                           | Solo                        |
| 0:40–0:50 | FIRST T38 — Privacy Awareness                                                                                  | Solo                        |
| 0:50–0:55 | Short break                                                                                                    | —                           |
| 0:55–1:15 | FIRST T39 — Accountability Under Pressure                                                                      | Solo                        |
| 1:15–1:30 | FIRST T40 — Ethical Leadership Reflection                                                                      | Solo                        |
| 1:30–1:45 | FIRST T41 — Professional Integrity Reflection: compare against T25                                             | Solo                        |
| 1:45–2:00 | FIRST T42 — Speak-Up Awareness                                                                                 | Solo                        |
| 2:00–2:20 | FIRST T43 — Ethical Decision Framework                                                                         | Solo                        |
| 2:20–2:35 | FIRST T44 — Professional Responsibility Statement                                                              | Solo                        |
| 2:35–2:55 | FIRST T45 — Integrity Audit + full-stage close                                                                 | Solo, then full-group share |

#### FACILITATOR NOTES

- This is the longest session in the stage; strongly consider splitting it across two meetings, most naturally between FIRST T39 and T40.
- FIRST T45 is a full-stage reflection, not just a Session 5 wrap-up — explicitly ask participants to look back across all five sections, both professionalism and ethics.
- Close by having each participant name one specific area of integrity strength and one specific remaining gap — concrete, not aspirational.